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FROM TOKYO TO FOREIGN OFFICE

Cypher/OTP

DEPARTMENTAL DISTRIBUTION

Sir E. Dening
No. 1675 (sic)
30th November, 1951.

D. 5.38 p.m. 30th November, 1951.
R. 6.57 p.m. 30th November, 1951.

FJ 10310/34

CONFIDENTIAL

Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No. 1675 [sic] of 30th November,
Repeated for information Washington

Exts Paris 570 - FJ10310/25

Your telegram No. 1361: Dulles' Talks.

Prime Minister, who dined with me last night, got on to the topic of Dulles' forthcoming visit. He seemed to think that Dulles wanted to press him about rearmament. He said that when Dulles spoke to him last February on this subject, he had indicated that Japan was in no position to rearm and that the best that could happen would be for Japan's industrial potential to be of assistance to American rearmament.

2. When I said that Mr. Dulles might conceivably want also to talk about China, Mr. Yoshida again had a ready answer which was that until the West had an agreed policy about China, there was nothing that Japan could do. He then pursued the theory of Japan as the bridge between the East and West which he enunciated to me on my first official call.

3. I thought it desirable to remind Mr. Yoshida that the Americans have their constitutional difficulties in the ratification of the peace treaty, and that in order to get a two-thirds majority, about half the Republicans as well as the Democrats will have to vote for ratification. Mr. Yoshida, if one is to judge from his attitude last night, may think he can successfully evade any pressure which Mr. Dulles and the Americans may put upon him, but if he is merely flippant, as he so often is, he may find himself in difficulties.

4. Mr. Kimura, who was also at the dinner, is off to Formosa tonight to take up his new post.

Foreign Office please pass to Washington as my telegram No. 103.

[Repeated to Washington]

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DEC 1951